labourers seeking employment on a daily basis. About 18 per cent of those employed are regular workers, and amongst them less than 8 per cent have regular, full-time employment with social protection

Table 4: Workers in the Organized/Unorganized Sectors

Workers	Unorganized Sector %	Organized Sector %	Total %
Informal Workers	82.6	9.8	92.4
Formal Workers	0.4	7.2	7.6
Total	83.0	17.0	100

Source: IHD 2014

Table 4 shows the overwhelming importance of the unorganized sector in providing employment with 83 per cent of total employment in the country. It also shows that there are more informal workers in both the organized and unorganized sectors, pointing to the vulnerable nature of jobs of the vast majority of people who are employed.

2. As is typical for a poor and developing economy, *most workers in India cannot afford to be unemployed, hence the level of open unemployment is quite low at 2.7 per cent*.

This point is particularly important. The National Sample Survey (NSS), on which much of our employment data is based, defines 'labour force' as '*those either working or actively seeking work*'. However, in India, many people in the working age group (15–59 years) do not seek work, knowing there are no employment opportunities. As they do not seek work they are excluded from the official definition of 'labour force' and hence are not counted as unemployed! In the NSS 2011–12 survey, 339 million people in the